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The Semester of Living Dangerously

For the parents of today's college students, a Visa was more likely to be needed for entering a country than for paying your way through college.

This chapter covers the most common ways that college students get into debt. It is a fact that today's collegians and new graduates are accumulating more debt than ever before. In the past, a college student who attempted to acquire a credit card would have been turned down. That situation is not true for college students today. There are now two requirements for most students to obtain a credit card—a college ID and a pulse! In fact, being wooed by credit card companies from the moment you step foot on a college campus has become a rite of passage.

Take a look at when most students are acquiring their first credit card:

Class Standing	
During High School	14%
After High School/Before College	20%
Freshman Year	46%
Sophomore Year	14%
After Sophomore Year	5%

*Source: Student Monitor 2000